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Writing the Literature review: Practical exercise

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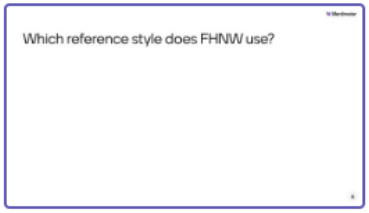
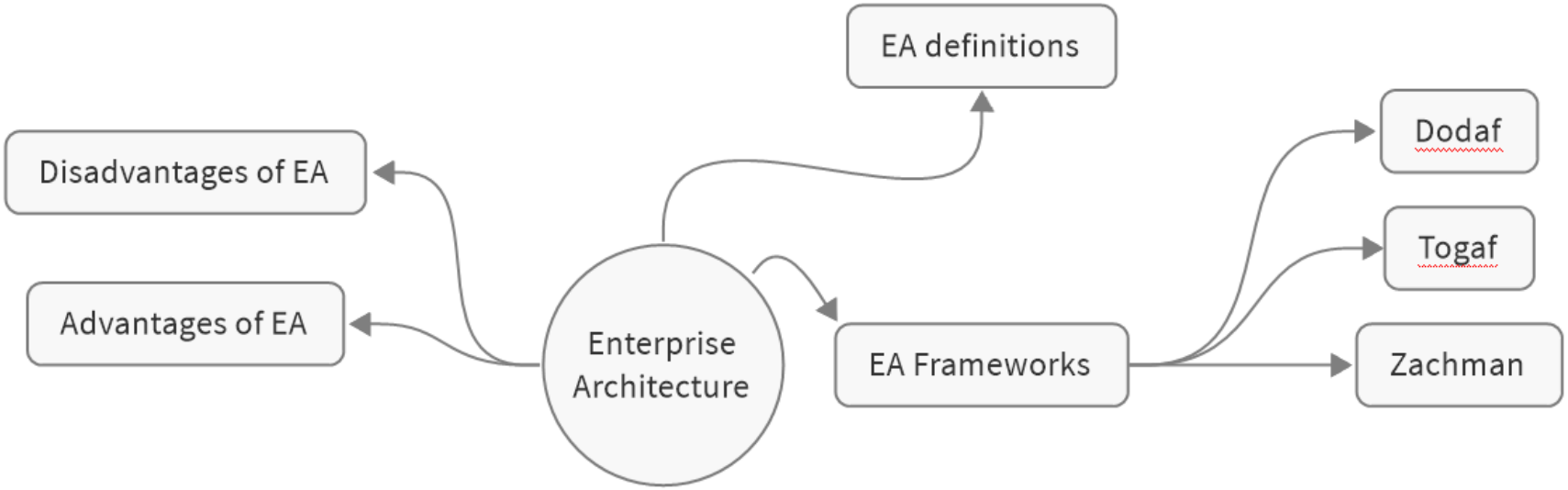


Two techniques to create do a literature review:

- Option 1: Create the structure before hand
- Option 2: Read and create the structure;


EA definitions
Disadvantages of EA
Dodaf
Togaf
Advantages of EA
Enterprise Architecture
EA Frameworks
Zachman

On writing a literature review

- Alta's way of doing a literature review:
  - Seek for references / articles
  - Add articles to Reference tool (e.g Word / Mendeley / Endnote)
  - Start with the more 'general works' (e.g books or frameworks)
  - Preferably on-line resources that you can easily tag

On writing a literature review

- Alta's way of doing a literature review:
  - Skim the abstract to see if the article / source is relevant (look at your statement against the wall)
  - Tag the concepts in the document. Create a Plagiarist file and add the concept into the file.
  - Add the reference;
  - Read further, if you encounter any concept relevant that you think you will use, create a heading in the document and copy and paste the reference into your plagiarist file.

Literature review: Gathering info

Plagiarist File

Definition of EA
EA is defined as …REF1
EA is defined as … REF2

Frameworks in EA
TOGAF
DODAF

Only add 'tags' and content for relevant information to your thesis statement …

Literature review: Writing

Plagiarist File

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EA is defined as …REF1
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Frameworks in EA
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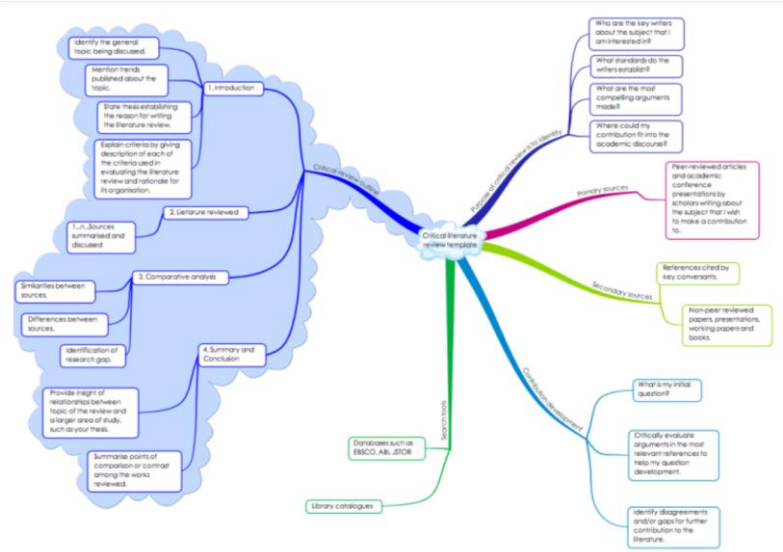
DODAF

Bibliography:
REF1…
REF 2….



30 September 2025

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Literature review: Writing

Plagiarist File

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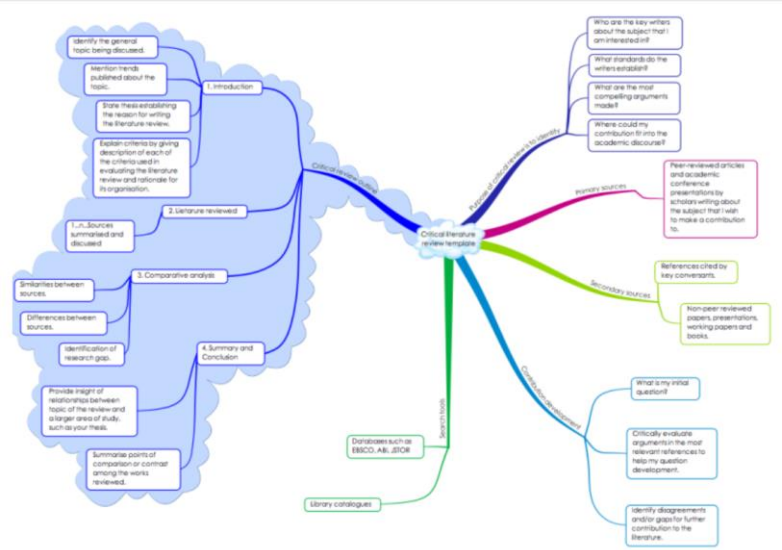

Chapter 2
Literature review

1. Introduction
…
2. EA Defined
EA is defined differently by different authors. According to REF 1, EA is defined as '….', this is in contrast with REF2 that defines ….. In this thesis EA is defined as … because …

Bibliography:
REF1…
REF2…

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Literature review: Writing

Chapter 2
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1. Introduction

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REF2…

Important:

- Everything that I take from other resources are referenced
- If directly quoted, use "text" and a page number in your reference e.g (Zachman, 2000:45)

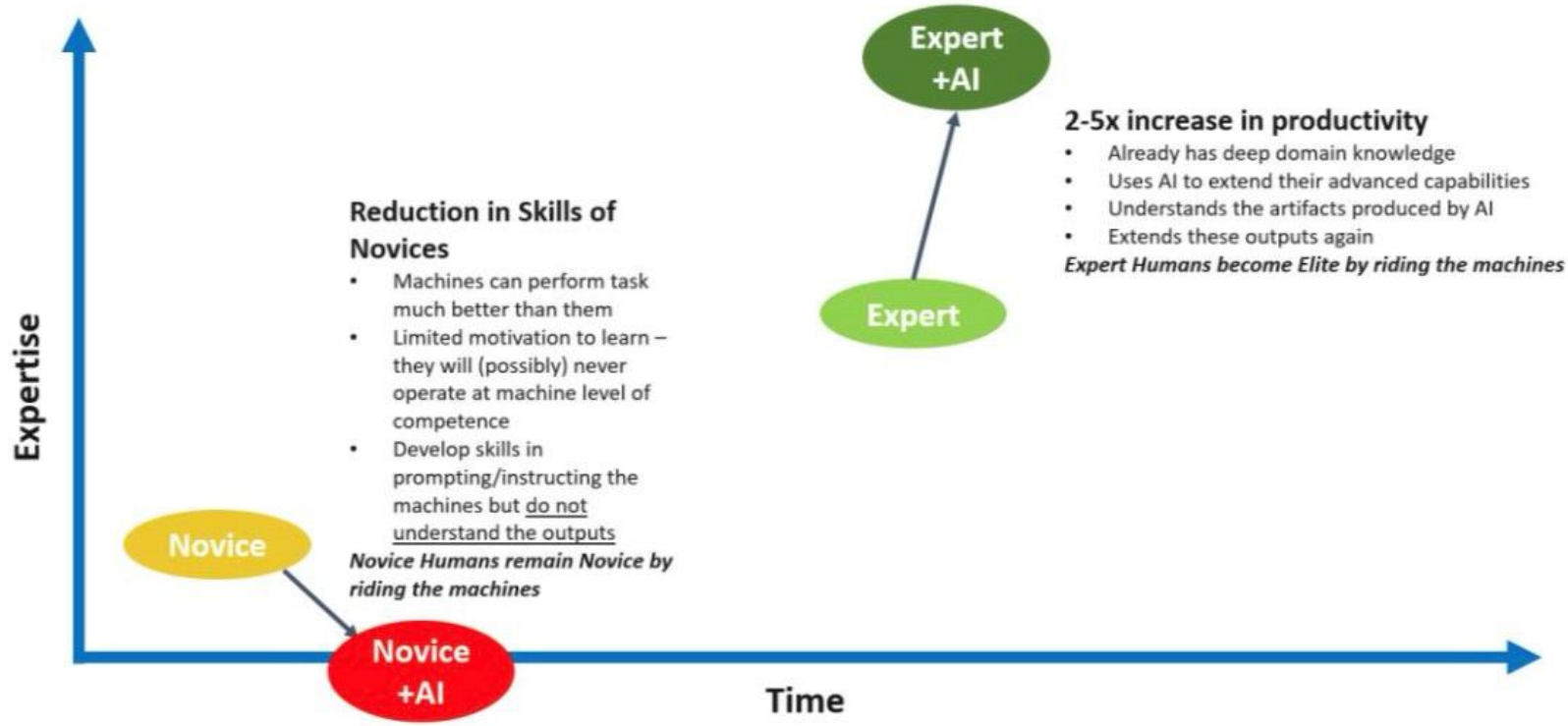
Use paraphrasing with referencing the work that you used

- Paraphrasing

- Remember to reference direct quotes – when you refer directly to text in a work (don't do this to much) remember to put it in quotes and include a page number in your reference.
  - Smith (2010:34) defines Enterprise Architecture as "a well-defined practice for conducting enterprise analysis, design … ".

So in the modern world of AI – do I still need to struggle with paraphrasing?

Figure 7: Experts vs Novices in the World of AI



Exercise

- Identify key sections that can go into your literature review
- Draw a chapter map (mind map) – free tool https://www.mindmup.com/ or MindManager on your software tools website https://web.fhnw.ch/ict/softwaredownload/liste.php?pf=Windows
- Include your mind map in the beginning of your chapter and also copy it to our mutual file in your tab.

You may use my method or any method that you prefer.